

Face to face with the adversary. Soviet foreign minister Andrei Gromyko (second from right) and Soviet ambassador to the United States Anatoly Dobrynin (third from right) meet with the president on October 18. Kennedy did not mention the missiles at this meeting, leading Gromyko to conclude that the Americans were in the dark. He was mistaken: not only did JFK know about the missiles, but he wanted them destroyed with an airstrike. (JFK LIBRARY)